

MyLearningLaunchpad · Executive Briefing Series

AI Strategy for Leaders

A Practical Playbook for Moving

from Hype to Execution

Strategic AI Framework · 2026 Edition

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"AI is Not the Problem. Thinking Is."

Most organizations struggle not because of AI, but because of how they approach it.

85%

of AI initiatives fail to scale beyond pilot stage

— Not a technology problem. A strategy problem.

What Most Organizations Are Doing

01

Chasing Tools

Jumping on the latest AI product without a clear use case or strategy.

02

Reacting to Hype

Letting vendor announcements and news cycles drive the AI roadmap.

03

Experimenting Without Structure

Running pilots that never scale, with no defined success criteria.

None of these are execution strategies.

Why AI Initiatives Fail

1

No Clear Problem

Teams deploy AI before defining the specific decision or workflow it should improve.

2

No System Design

AI is treated as a feature, not a component of an integrated workflow architecture.

3

No Ownership

Projects lack a sponsor with accountability for outcomes and adoption at scale.

These failures compound. Fix the foundation before adding AI.

< 30%

of AI projects
reach production

\$2.5B+

wasted annually
on AI pilots

67%

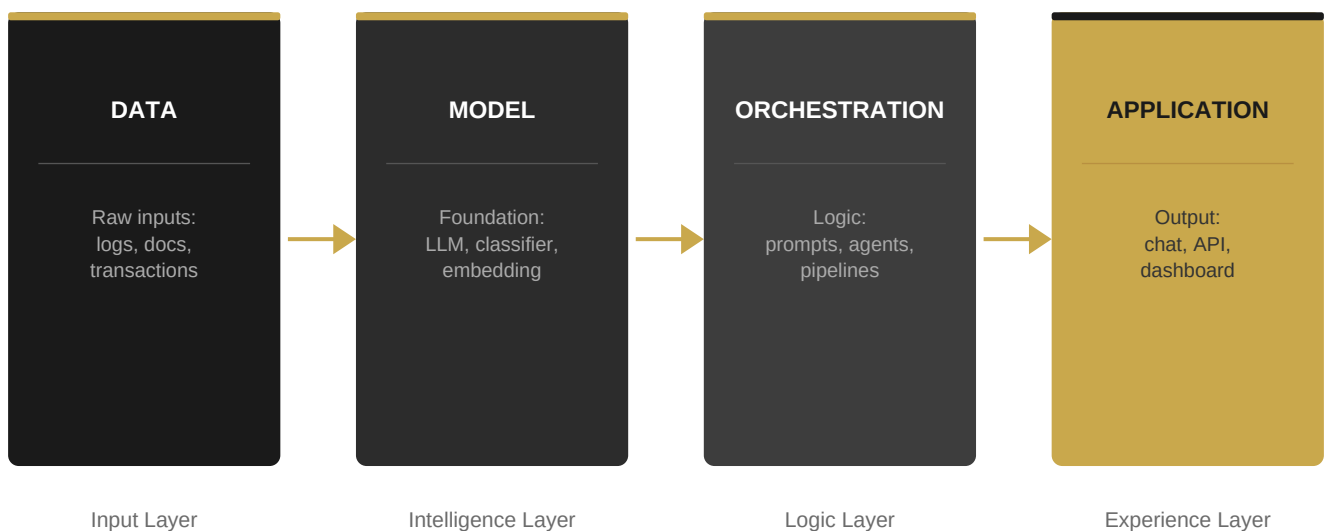
cite unclear
objectives

"AI is not a tool.

AI is a system."

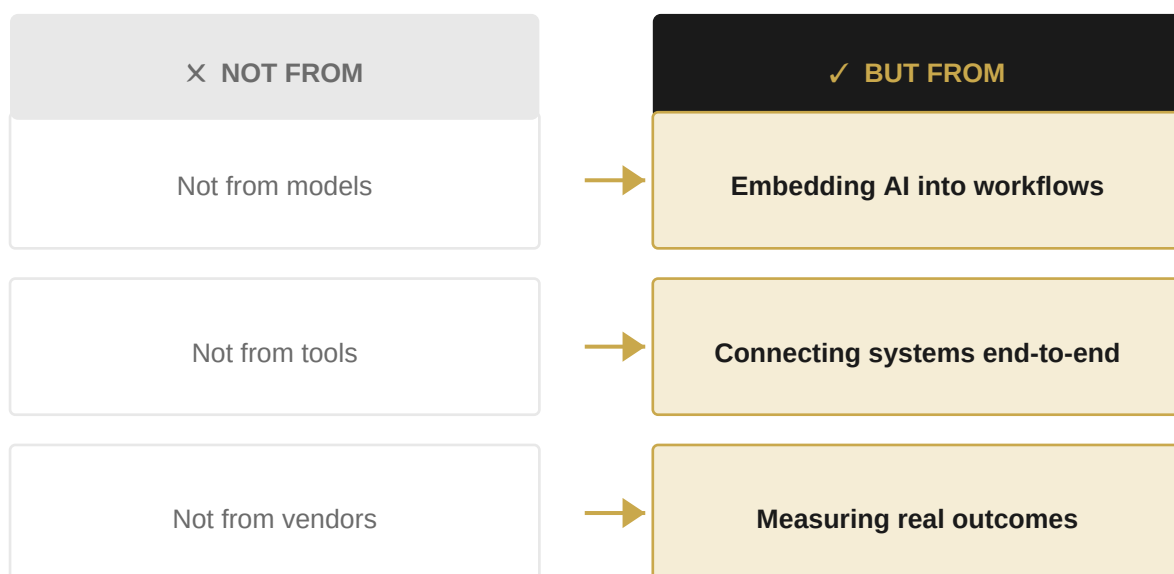
This distinction changes everything about how you build.

The Four Layers of AI in Production



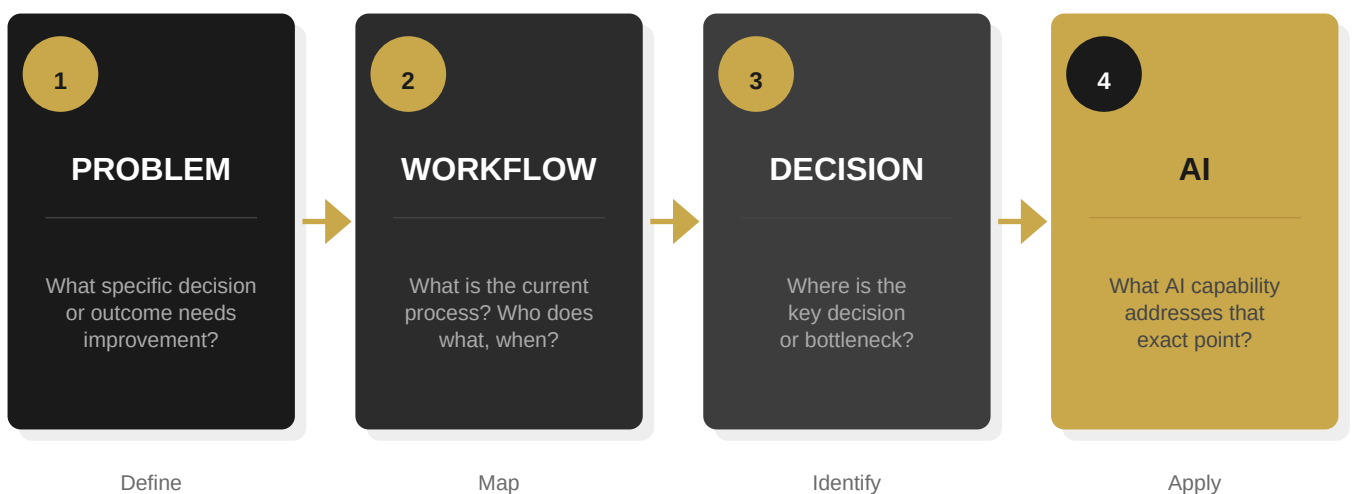
Value emerges from how these layers connect — not from any single component.

Value Comes From Integration



**The competitive advantage is in the workflow,
not the model.**

The Right Sequence Matters



Start with the problem. Let the problem define the AI.

Never start with the tool and work backwards.

The Four Failure Patterns

Tool-First Thinking

Selecting AI tools before defining the problem or success criteria.

No Ownership

AI projects without a clear sponsor and accountability chain fail silently.

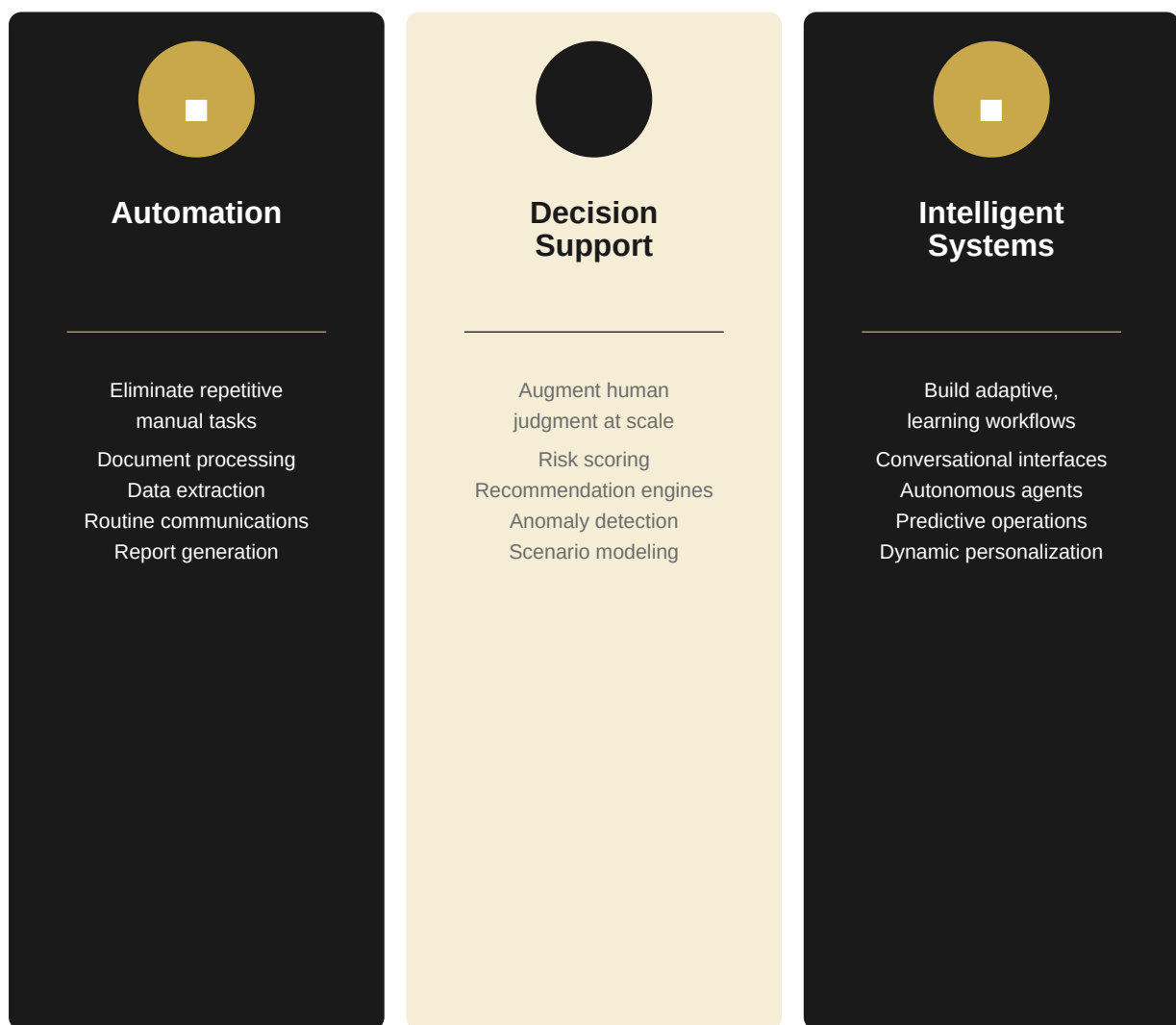
Poor Integration

AI bolted onto existing workflows rather than redesigning the process around AI.

Side Experiment Mindset

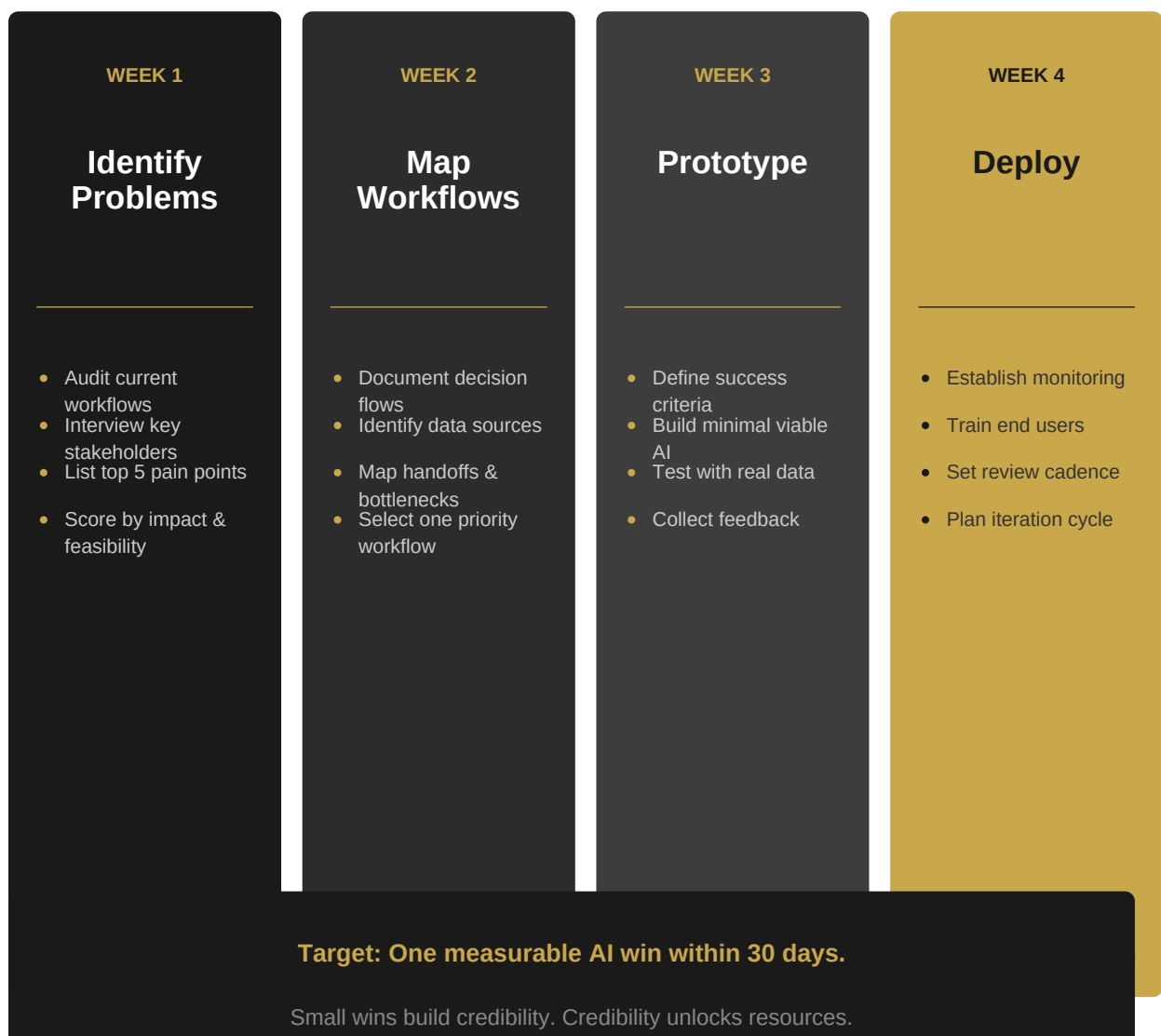
Treating AI as R&D rather than a core operational capability with KPIs.

Where AI Creates Value



Maturity: Low Complexity → Medium → High Complexity

From Insight to Action



From Clarity to Execution

This playbook is a starting point.

Real execution requires the right framework,
the right questions, and the right guidance.

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